



Activity File: Persistence

- In this activity, you will continue to play the role of a pen tester conducting an engagement on MegaCorpOne.
- In the previous activity, you accessed the shadow file and cracked several passwords in it.
- You will now conduct the post-exploitation task of persistence by adding an additional port for the SSH service to listen on and then opening the port on a firewall.
- Then, you will create a privileged account to SSH to your new hidden port, so that you can reaccess your target.

Reminder: Ensure that you are performing the activities on the target machine and not your own assessment machine! This means you should be SSH'd in, or have a reverse/Meterpreter shell into the target.

⚠ Reminder - Don't forget to save your findings, as you will add them to your report!

Instructions

1. On the target host, read the top 10 lines of the SSH config file, located at `/etc/ssh/sshd_config`, and identify the line where a port is specified.
2. Using Nano, edit the file to add an additional port, 10022. (You must `sudo` to do this.)
 - Due to this machine having limited services, you must restart it to restart the SSH service. Restart the machine via `sudo reboot`.
3. Now, create a new backdoor account. To remain inconspicuous, name this account so that it appears as if it's a service. Create a new account named "systemd-ssh", with the password "password", and then add it to the admin group.
4. Confirm that the new account works by SSHing from your machine to the target host over port 10022 as the new user you created.
 - Use the following command to ssh with a different port: `ssh -p 10022 systemd-ssh@ipaddress`